Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

894
-15 -1.65%
Apr 4th, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1006
-17.00 -1.66%
Apr 4th, 2023

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

828
-1 -0.12%
Apr 4th, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

144.75
0.00 0.00%
Apr 4th, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

148.40
-0.40 -0.27%
Apr 4th, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1015
20 2.01%
Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2305 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

881.50
-9.00 -1.01%
Apr 4th, 2023 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
May 23 USD/dmt

118.80
-1.60 -1.33%
Apr 4th, 2023 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2305 (Jan) RMB/t

4018
-26 -0.64%
Apr 4th, 2023 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

21.51
0.51 2.43%
Apr 3rd, 2023

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

8.18
0.28 3.48%
Apr 3rd, 2023

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

4260
50 1.19%
Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

131.02
-1.48 -1.12%
Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

17.31
-0.53 -2.95%
Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

4350
50 1.16%
Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Apr 4th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	894	-15	-1.7%	869	880	858	892	121.26	-1.91	-1.6%	120.06	120.58	117.93	122.93
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	828	-1	-0.1%	813	798	761	793	113.25	0.03	0.0%	113.29	110.17	105.29	110.04
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1006	-17	-1.7%	981	992	970	1003	136.94	-2.17	-1.6%	136.05	136.43	133.84	138.73

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Apr 4th, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	144.75	0.00	0.00%	112.19	123.51	83.90	159.45
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	148.40	-0.40	-0.27%	122.51	139.95	94.45	185.82

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures declined by 2.06% today, the main contract closed at 881.5.The traders' willingness to ship is less. The steel mills are less active to purchase. The overall trading sentiment of the market is negative. PBF at Shandong port deal 888-898 yuan/mt, decrease 4-14 yuan/mt ; SSF at Shandong port deal 765 yuan/mt .PBF at Tangshan port deal 900 yuan/mt, decrease 15-18yuan/mt. The current market sentiment is still pessimistic due to the demand for finished products. First, the rainy weather before and after the Tomb Sweeping Day may affect the terminal construction. Second, the holidays also affect some demand. From the perspective of imported iron ore fundamentals, the current pattern has not changed much, but with the recovery of overseas supply in the later stage, the supply-demand contradiction may gradually accumulate. In the short term, iron ore prices continue to fluctuate widely.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1015	20	2.0%	920	1033	770	1405	132.31	3.65	2.84%	118.08	138.23	94.72	199.13

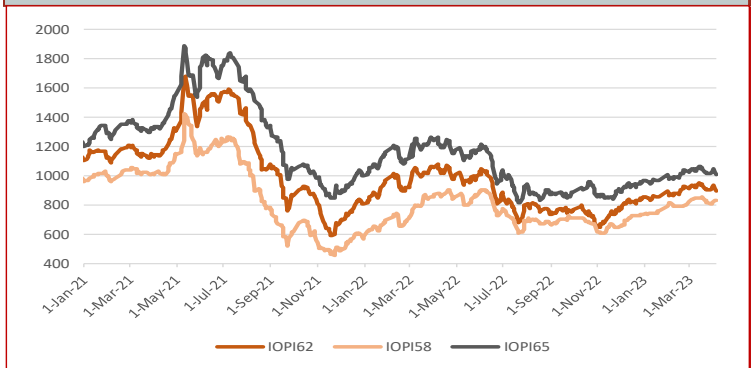
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1037	-6.3%	779	1645	150.80	-6.48%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1100	1.4%	780	1630	159.96	1.21%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	835	-1.2%	620	1310	121.42	-1.35%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1054	-7.0%	800	1752	153.27	-7.13%	117.19	272.32

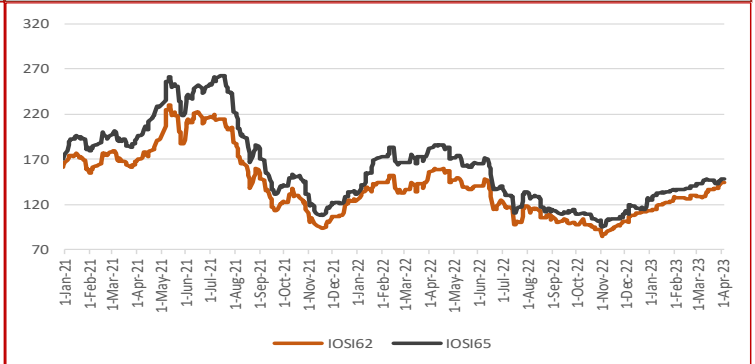
Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	966.69	-1.74%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.8651

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Apr 4th, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	822	856	892	924	869	881	880	109.43	117.00	121.64	124.91	120.06	120.90	120.58
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	711	751	799	832	813	792	798	95.17	103.34	109.79	113.41	113.29	109.35	110.17
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	935	968	1003	1036	981	993	992	124.90	132.80	137.36	140.49	136.05	136.72	136.43

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Apr 4th, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	108.92	119.76	127.73	134.77	112.19	111.97	123.51
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	116.83	132.39	138.06	145.14	122.51	122.73	139.95

FREIGHT RATES

Apr 3rd, 2023		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	8.18	0.28	3.48%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	21.51	0.51	2.43%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD	December	January	February	March	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	922	964	988	1012	920	918	1033	117.06	126.47	129.95	131.15	118.52	118.76	138.13

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Apr 4th, 2023		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-66	-7.38%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	112	12.53%

Apr 4th, 2023		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	3.65	2.52%

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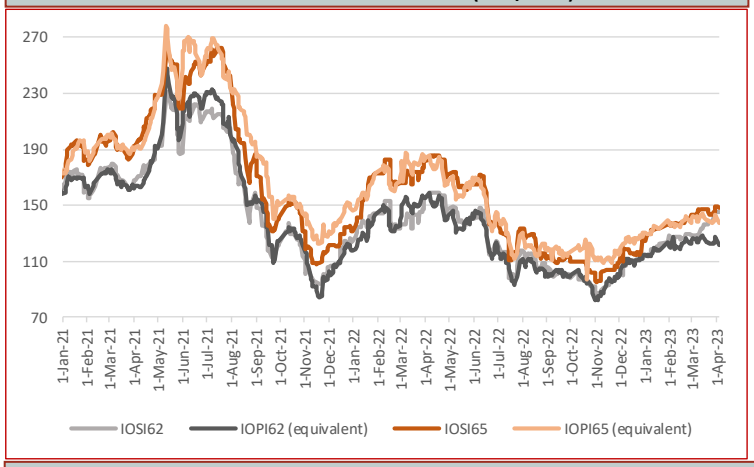
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Apr 4th, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	837	-15	-57
SIMEC Fines	767	-15	-127
PB Fines	862	-15	-32
Newman Fines	863	-15	-31
MAC Fines	844	-15	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	759	-15	-135
Carajas Fines	1075	-15	181
Brazilian SSF	859	-15	-35
Brazilian Blend Fines	875	-15	-19
RTX Fines	777	-15	-117
West Pilbara Fines	805	-15	-89

Apr 4th, 2023	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	140.25	0.00	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	136.75	0.00	-8.00
PB Fines	141.00	0.00	-3.75
Newman Fines	143.90	0.00	-0.85
MAC Fines	141.00	0.00	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	133.40	0.00	-11.35
Carajas Fines	174.30	0.00	29.55
Brazilian SSF	148.50	0.00	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	150.15	0.00	5.40
RTX Fines	134.65	0.00	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	139.00	0.00	-5.75

Apr 4th, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	828	-1	0
FMG Blended Fines	838	-1	10
Robe River	839	-1	11
Western Fines	842	-1	14
Atlas Fines	835	-1	7
Yandi	820	-1	-8

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	7.00	1.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	5.00	0.00
	Low Grade Fe	14.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	37.00	1.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	9.00	-1.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	58.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	10.00	-2.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	12.00	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	24.00	1.00
	Low Fe Grade	5.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	8.00	2.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	8.00	2.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	2.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	1.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	1.50	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	1.50	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	1.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	0.25	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	2.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	3.00	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	0.25	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	5.00	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-10.00	0.00	Jingtang	-10.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	-15.00	0.00

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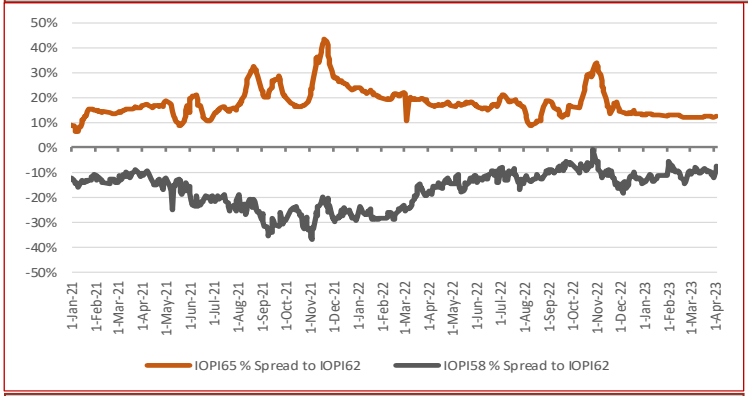
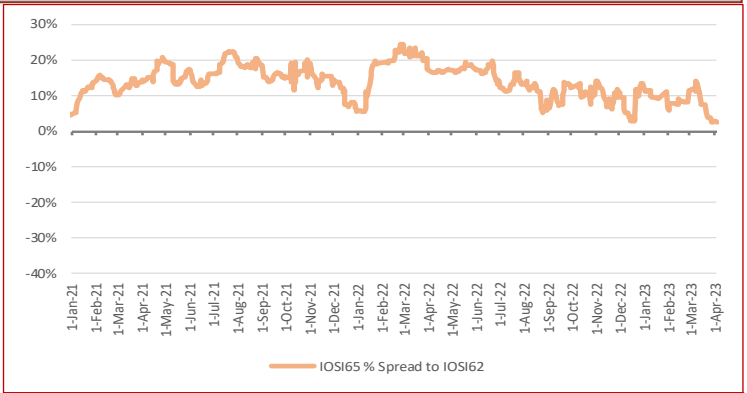
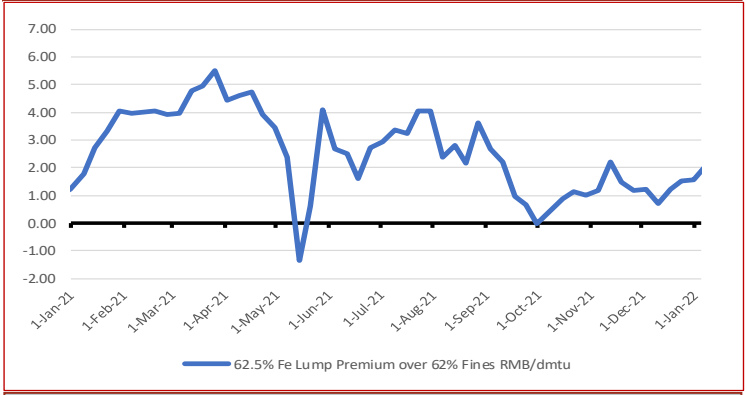
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

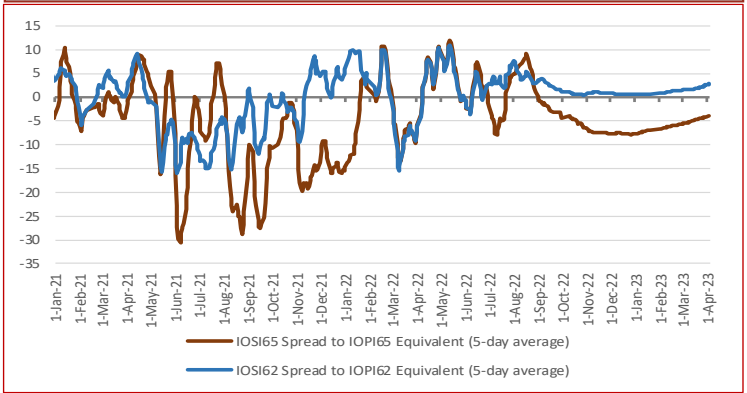




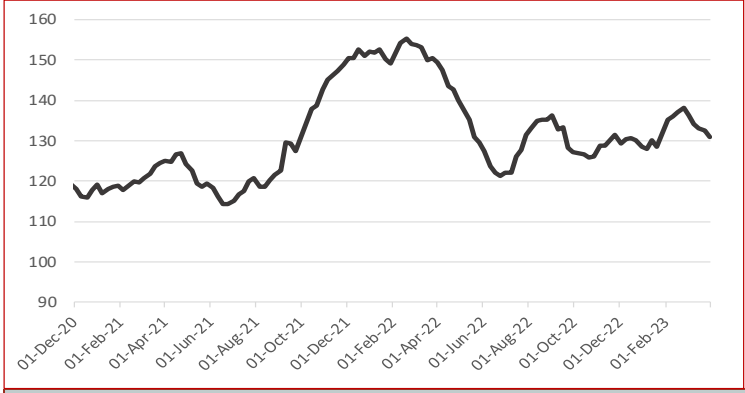
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



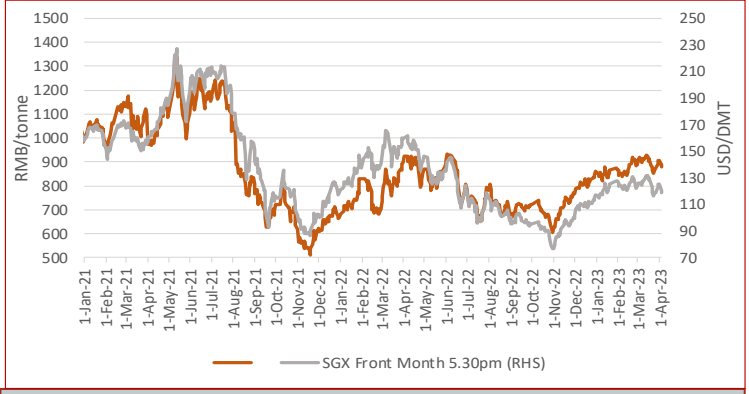
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

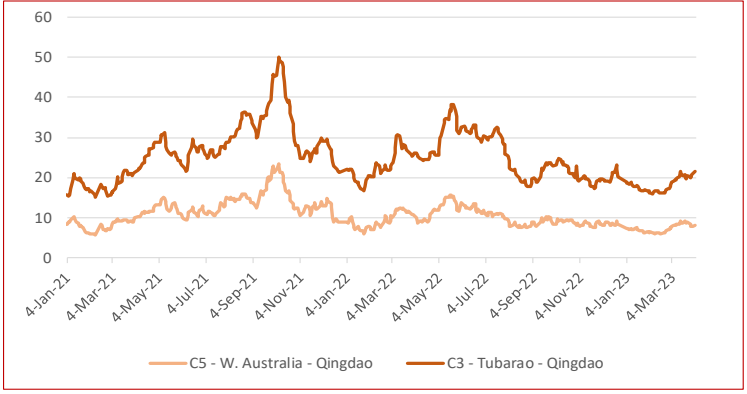
Week Ending Mar 31st, 2023

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	13.16	1.46%	9.84	19.20
Qingdao	24.75	-1.98%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	11.90	-2.70%	9.05	16.29
Tianjin	9.78	-1.31%	7.14	12.97
Rizhao	17.72	-6.39%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	131.02	-1.12%	98.80	155.39

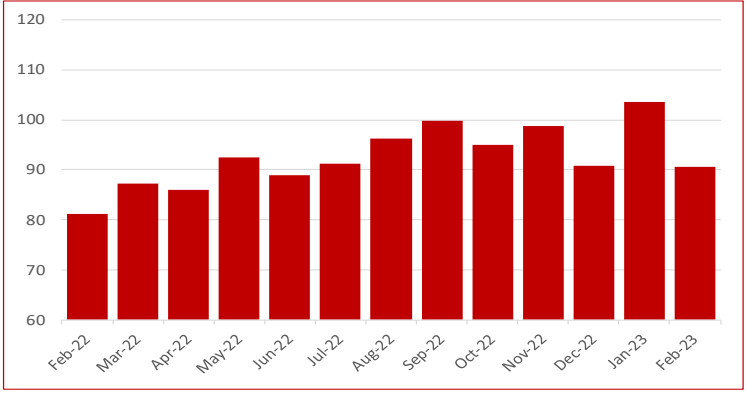
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Apr 4th, 3pm close			Apr 4th, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2305	Change	Change %	May. 23	Change	Change %
Closing Price	881.50	-9.00	-1.01%	118.80	-1.60	-1.33%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	40.49	-3.93	-8.84%	6.72	4.81	251.17%
Open positions ('000 lots)	44.98	-5.65	-11.16%	26.40	2.39	9.93%
Day Low	873.5	-15.50	-1.74%	117.05	-4.25	-3.50%
Day High	897.0	-14.50	-1.59%	121.55	-5.25	-4.14%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2023/3/31	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	4,260	50	1.19%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	4,470	50	1.13%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	4,350	50	1.16%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,790	20	0.42%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	4,470	40	0.90%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	5,120	20	0.39%
Colour Coated Plate	7,500	0	0.00%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

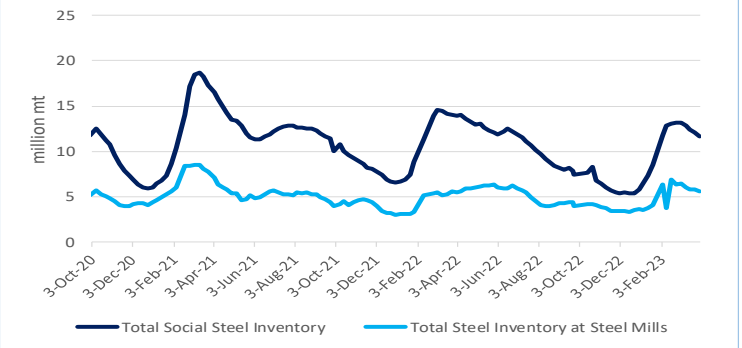
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	144.75	7	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	2,960	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	3,120	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,638	10	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	4,145	11	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	35	19	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	4,154	14	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	186	36	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

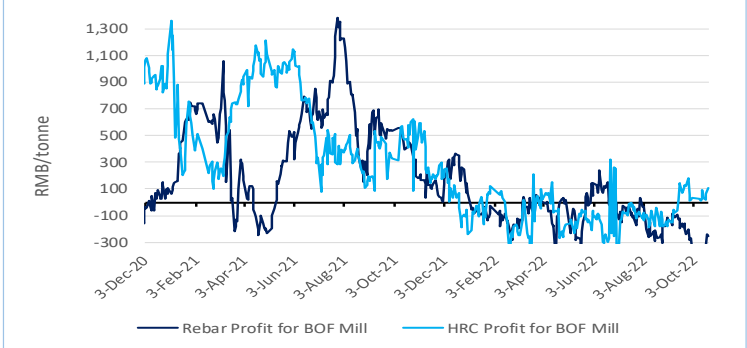
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

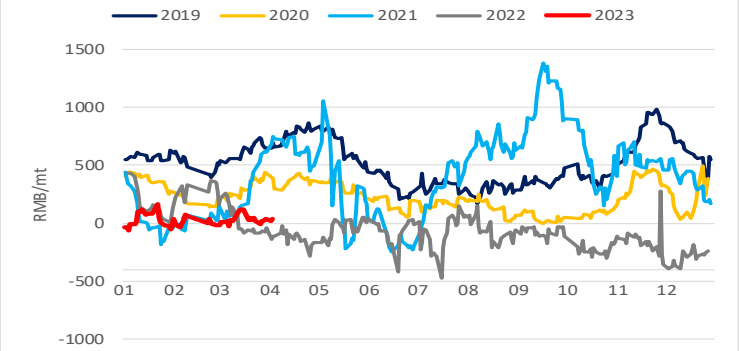
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



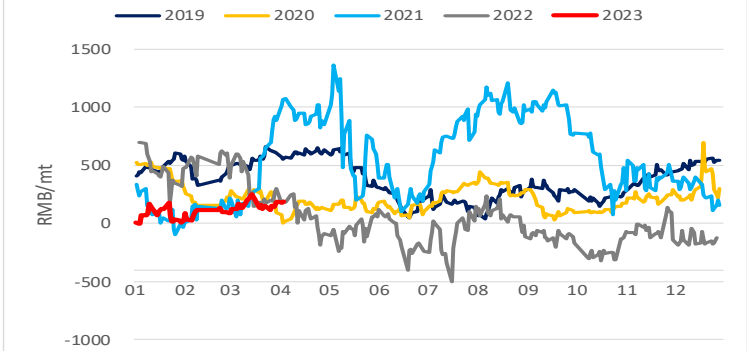
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



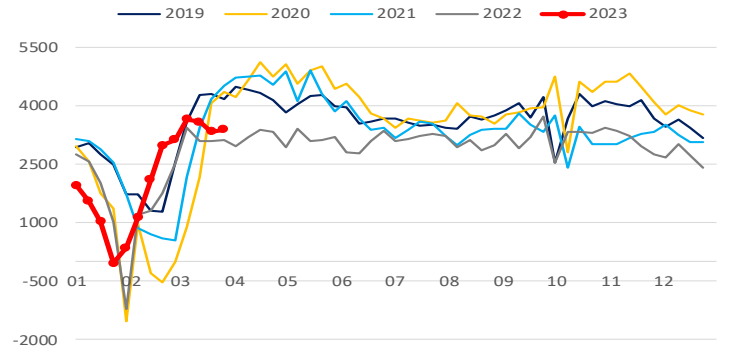
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



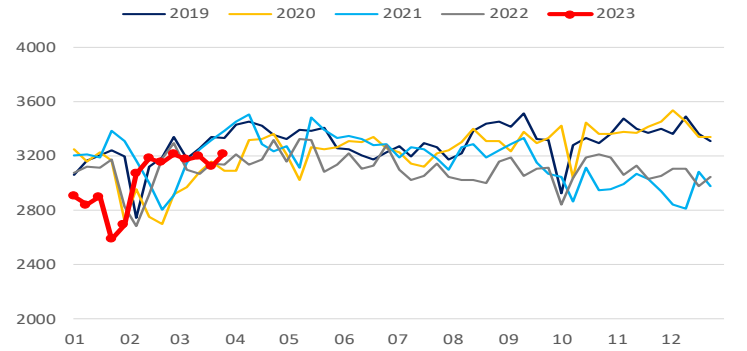
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



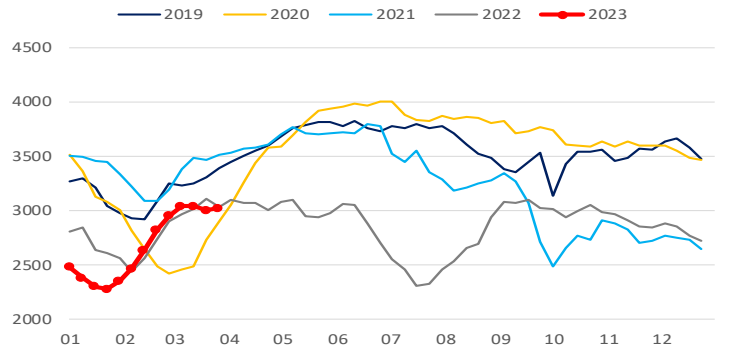
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



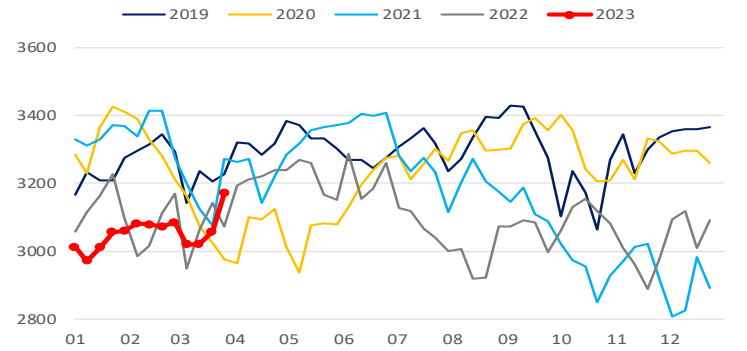
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Apr 4th, 2023	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Apr 4th, 2023	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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